

The Gender Gap in Teen Reading



Among OECD Members & 5 partner economies above the OECD reading average

Mean score ▸

400 425 446 OECD avg. for boys 476 OECD avg. for girls 500 525 550

Singapore
China
Taiwan
South Korea
*New Zealand
Macao
Estonia
Ireland
Japan
Australia
*United States
*Canada
United Kingdom
Poland
Finland
Italy
Sweden
Lithuania
Hong Kong
Switzerland
Czechia
Belgium
Türkiye
Austria
Portugal
Germany
Denmark
*Norway
France
Slovenia
Slovakia
Spain
Hungary
*Netherlands
Luxembourg
Israel
Latvia
Greece
Chile
Iceland
Costa Rica
Mexico
Colombia

◂ China specifically refers to Beijing, Shanghai, Jiangsu, and Zhejiang.

Girls outread boys in all 43 systems shown.

Of the 90 education systems tested worldwide, Rwanda is the only one where boys scored higher than girls.

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Source: OECD PISA 2025 Results (Volume I). PISA tests representative samples of 15-year-olds in each system.
**Indicates low school and student participation, with rates falling below international quality standards.*